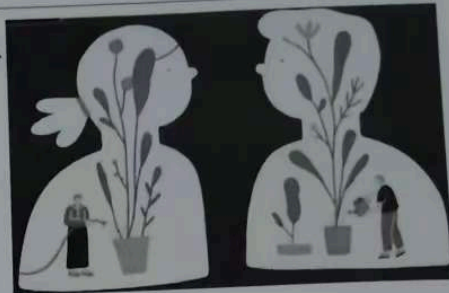


Being close to nature was like food for my soul. So I felt a surge of 1 to discover that our new house has a backyard filled with birds and trees — including a lemon tree. I 2 picking its juicy fruit, and taking shade under its leafy limbs. Then I went to take a closer look at the tree. It was 3! The branches were tangled with no sunlight breaking through. The leaves were bug-infested. Oh, and the lemons? Most of them were 4 or went bad.



"I've tried to help it, but I think it might be a lost 5," said my husband, Werner. Yet somehow I felt called to 6 the lemon tree.

So I began to work on it, 7 some heavy-laden branches. Then I watered it 8, added fertilizer, and controlled the bugs. A few weeks later, I 9 something: New fruit had grown in and this time all of the lemons were 10. The branches had opened up, letting sunlight through. Encouraged by these signs of 11, I continued to look after it with 12 and patience.

Today, it stands tall and magnificent, growing juicy yellow lemons that we 13 with our neighbors. "I can't believe the tree grows so well!" Werner said, "You did an 14 job." It wasn't just me. The lemon tree is a living 15 that anything can grow and blossom in the hands of the one who nurtures it all.

1. A. excitement B. power C. inspiration D. pride
2. A. avoided B. missed C. imagined D. practiced
3. A. beyond description *无法形容* B. out of reach *够不着* C. under control *处于控制之下* D. in a mess *一团糟*
4. A. inactive *不活跃* B. misshapen *畸形的* C. unstable *不稳定的* D. dissimilar *不同的*
5. A. chance B. dream C. hope D. cause
6. A. plant B. observe C. save D. remove
7. A. cutting down B. giving away C. lifting up D. leaving behind
8. A. secretly B. tirelessly C. constantly D. regularly
9. A. noticed B. heard C. demonstrated D. expected
10. A. nutritious B. healthy C. delicious D. fresh
11. A. evolution *进化* B. strength *力量* C. creativity *创造力* D. progress *进步*
12. A. tolerance *宽容* B. devotion C. curiosity *好奇心* D. gratitude *感恩*
13. A. sell B. cook C. share D. exchange
14. A. amazing B. interesting C. effective D. urgent
15. A. instruction B. proof C. target D. foundation

One winter evening, I was driving home through a snowstorm. Suddenly, I noticed a vehicle ~~1~~ me. I found it somewhat ~~disturbing~~ ^{令人不安}, but I didn't give it much thought. Then, without warning, my tyre burst with a(n) ~~2~~ bang! I wrestled with the steering wheel to maintain ~~3~~ and carefully pulled off the road, my heart pounding. I ~~4~~ on my hazard lights, hoping for assistance.

To my astonishment, the car behind me also ~~5~~. A man swiftly emerged from the driver's seat. He came over to my car and inquired if I was unharmed. Still in a state of shock, I nodded ~~6~~. Without a moment's hesitation, he got down to ~~7~~. He took out a spare ~~8~~

from my trunk and began the task of replacing the ~~9~~ one. Despite the terrible weather, he worked with remarkable ~~precision~~ ^{精确度} and ~~10~~ ^{非内附}.

Once he had finished, he ~~11~~ his hands on a cloth and remarked, "I was planning to ~~12~~ two kilometres back. But something about that tyre seemed ~~13~~ to me. I'm glad I decided to follow you along the way. You never know what might happen on a night like this."

I was overwhelmed with gratitude. I thanked him sincerely, but he just smiled ~~14~~ and said, "No problem. Just be careful out there." He got back into his car and drove away, leaving me with a profound sense of ~~15~~ for his selflessness.

As I continued my journey, the snow continued to fall, but the road seemed a little less daunting.

- B 1. A. stopping B. tailing C. screaming D. dismissing
- C 2. A. amazing B. eye-catching C. deafening ^{震耳欲聋} D. wide-ranging
- A 3. A. control B. speed C. energy D. level
- ✓ D 4. A. leaned B. pointed C. bounced D. switched
- C 5. A. pulled down B. took over C. pulled over D. got down
- B 6. A. literally ^{字面上} B. weakly ^{虚弱地} C. definitely ^{肯定地} D. vigorously ^{精力充沛地}
- A 7. A. business B. chores C. ground D. reality
- ✓ D 8. A. seat B. wheel ^{轮子} C. light D. tyre ^{轮胎}
- A 9. A. flat B. solid C. odd D. repaired
- C 10. A. outlook ^{展望} B. fantasy C. efficiency ^{效率} D. vitality ^{活力}
- B 11. A. shook B. wiped C. wrapped D. clapped
- B 12. A. flee ^{逃跑} B. exit C. flash D. slide
- A 13. A. off B. in C. out D. down
- ✓ D 14. A. rigidly ^{严格地} B. scarcely ^{几乎不} C. exclusively ^{专门地} D. modestly ^{适度地}
- ✓ D 15. A. permission B. anticipation C. competence D. admiration

